When India became independent in 1947, food security (simply put, having enough nutritious food available) was an area of concern. Despite having a large rural population engaged in agriculture, India did not produce enough food grain to sustain its population and had to rely on agreements with other nations to import enough food all the way up to the 1960s.

A green revolution

Swaminathan arranged for demonstrations of the new wheat in Indian farmers' own fields as a means of convincing them to grow it. He also helped modify the colour of the Mexican wheat from its original red to a more familiar amber, which made farmers more open to eating it. The efforts he made to work directly with farmers were crucial to the project's success. In 1968, India's wheat production grew from 12 million tonnes to 17 million tonnes, sparking what would be called the 'green revolution'. Since then, India's foodgrain production has risen consistently. Swaminathan's own career has also been distinguished: he has held numerous prestigious posts, both in India (notably in the Ministry of Agriculture and the Planning Commission) and elsewhere, and he was awarded the very first World Food Prize in 1987.



In 1968, the Indira Gandhi-led government issued this stamp to commemorate India's strides in wheat production. The success of India's green revolution spread to other countries as well, with several